- All colours required to print can be achieved in one process itself
- Versatile in colours, pattern and scale

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Disadvantages

- Required skilled labour
- Laborious process
- Production cost is more for printing in small quantities
- Creation of engraved rollers is expensive
- Time consuming process
- If rollers are not aligned properly, it results in one or more colours falling out of position

3.5.3 Stencil Printing

In stencil printing, the design is first traced on the cardboard, wood, metal or plastic sheets with marker pens or pencils. Using scissors, knife or sharp blade the design is cut out. The uncut portion represents the part that is to be left uncoloured. When cutting the stencil care must be taken that small patterns must be cut through first. If large patterns are cut over or keeping small pattern inside then the smaller designs would be cut away with it. The stencil is placed on the fabric to be printed and the printing paste is applied with stencil brush through its interstices. When printing is repeated, care must be taken that the stencil on face side does not take up dye. Other colours can be applied on the design when the first colour dries. This method is suitable for both fine delicate design and large space design.



Figure 3.9. Preparing Stencil



Figure 3.10. Stencil Printing



Figure 3.11 Stencil Printed Bag

Advantages

- Low budget investment
- Exclusive designs and intricacy

Disadvantage

- Unevenness on printing table leads to uneven printing

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